The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Purifying All Obstacles"

Āryasarvāntarāyikaviśodhanī-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 926 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་བར་དུ་གྱིས་བཅས་ཅད་རྣམ་པར་སྦྱོང་བ་ཞེས་བྱ་བའི་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Purifying All Obstacles," known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Sarvāntarāyaviśodhanī Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Phakpa Bardu Chöpa Tamché Nampar Jongwa, is a short scripture centered on a dhāraṇī, a sacred incantation believed to protect and purify those who recite it. It opens at the Indraśaila Cave on Mount Vaidehaka, north of the brahmin village of Āmraṣaṇḍā near Rājagṛha, where Śakra, lord of the gods, comes to the Buddha in fear after recognizing the omens that his life is nearly spent and that death and rebirth await him. Accompanied by his consorts and attendants, he pays homage and seeks the Buddha's help, setting the stage for a teaching on overcoming obstacles to life and well-being. The work is Toh 926 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the collection of dhāraṇī texts.

In the language of India: ārya sarva antarāyaki viśodhani nāma dhāraṇī
In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Purifying All Obstacles."

Homage to the Buddha.
Homage to the Dharma.
Homage to the Saṅgha.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling in the Indraśaila Cave on Mount Vaidehaka. The mountain lies to the north of the brahmin village called Āmraṣaṇḍā, which is east of Rājagṛha.

At that time Śakra, lord of the gods, had become subject to death and transmigration. He understood the omens showing that only a remnant of his life's formations remained, and fear arose in him. Together with his retinue of consorts and his servants, he went to the Blessed One. He bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet, circumambulated him three times, and sat down to one side, seeking to have his life once more.

The Blessed One said to him: "Kauśika, for this reason, listen to these bases of awareness-mantra of yours, by which all māras, all opponents, and all adversaries will be utterly vanquished. These are the bases of awareness-mantra called 'Purifying All Obstacles':

tadyathā abhaye bhayavigate bhayapariśvadhane abhaye abhayaṃdade niruvakliṣṭi anakule akulavariśodhane agrate avikalpe avikalpane acyute

śubhe śubhe tejastejovati śame upaśame mahopaśame maitri maitryuddhite toṣe toṣayaṇe satye satyadarṣi aviruddhe sahite sihitatve arthe arthasiddhe amṛte amṛtapate abhīte vajrasatye akṣaye akṣayaprabhe drantravare śuddhe śuddhe prabhe avabhāse avabhāsavati upayoge anuttare samacitte buddha adhiṣṭhāne śīle viśodhane asaṃharye sunigṛhītaṃ marabalānāṃ parajayo dṛṣṭigatrāṇāṃ jvalanaṃ dharmolkāyai utghaṭānāṃ dharmanidhanasya saṃgrahāṇāṃ dharmakoṣasya

Kauśika, these are your bases of awareness-mantra, by which all māras, all opponents, and all adversaries will be utterly vanquished. If one recites this, then, except for the karmic maturation of past actions, all obstacles will be purified, and all aims will be accomplished as well."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, Śakra, lord of the gods, rejoiced, and at that time he uttered this inspired utterance:

"I have not fallen from the gods;
While remaining right here,
I have gained life anew.
Friends, know that it is so."

By all the power of this, may all my obstacles, obstructors, and vināyakas cease to be. May every excellence be accomplished.

namo aketulenge caṇḍanaye svāhā sarva artha sādhaniye svāhā dharmartha sādhaniye svāhā sarvā antarāyi viśodhaniye svāhā

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, Śakra, lord of the gods, together with his retinue of consorts and his retinue, and the entire assembly rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This concludes the noble dhāraṇī called "Purifying All Obstacles."

It was translated, edited, and finalized by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla and the chief editor and translator, Bandé Yeshé Dé.

Translator's Notes

• The setting matches the Śakrapraśna sūtra (Pāli Sakkapañha), set in the Indraśāla/Indraśaila cave on Mount Vediyaka (Skt. Vaidehaka) north of the brahmin village Ambasaṇḍā, east of Rājagṛha. "Mount Vaidehaka" follows the Tibetan "Videha mountain." The Tibetan village name, literally "Place of Mango Trees," is given as Āmraṣaṇḍā, the Sanskrit counterpart of Pāli Ambasaṇḍā. The exact Sanskrit form is not certain; it may also appear as Āmraṣaṇḍikā. In the Blessed One's first naming of the mantra, the text reads □□□□□□□, but the title has □□□□□□□ ("purifying"). It is translated as "purifying," as the title reads. The phrase "these are your bases

of awareness-mantra" renders the somewhat awkward Tibetan "□□□□□□□□□□."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.